abducted, and quickly connected the two events. The crowds that day were not huge, only a few dozen local youth fighting with police. At times there seemed to be more journalists than protesters (not an unusual phenomenon here).

But they were the largest clashes that had been seen in East Jerusalem for decades—the biggest since the first intifada, residents said. They dragged on for twelve hours; at one point the imam of the local mosque came down and urged protesters to break their Ramadan fasts. “He said anyone who is fighting has permission to eat and drink,” one protester, Yazid, told me. The staccato pop of sound bombs echoed down empty streets, and clouds of thick black smoke lingered in the air where protesters had burned tires. The pavement was a carpet of rocks. It fizzled out after sunset, only to resume the next day, and the day after that. Hundreds of people were injured, hundreds more arrested.

The Israeli press dismissed it as pointless rioting. Though the cause justified the anger, what ensued seemed to compound the hopelessness. Veolia, the company that operated the light rail, said it would take weeks to repair the damage to tracks and stations. Streets and sidewalks were broken apart for ammunition. A poorly-aimed Molotov cocktail even went through an upper window of the Abu Khdair family home, though the fire was quickly extinguished.

However, there was also a half-century’s worth of frustration to account for. When Israel occupied East Jerusalem in 1967, most residents had elected not to become Israeli citizens. Instead they were treated as a special category, allowed to move and work freely, but not to vote in national elections. They were also subject to losing their legal status if they moved out of Jerusalem. More than 14,300 Palestinians have had their residency revoked since 1967 (though Israel has scaled back this practice in recent years).

Half a century after the occupation, there remains a vast disparity between east and west on virtually every indicator. Among East Jerusalem residents, 75 per cent live below the poverty line, and one-third of children do not complete a full twelve years of school. Building permits in the east are expensive and difficult to obtain, and the resultant housing crisis has pushed population density to nearly twice the level of the west. Basic services are scarce, from health care to sewage to post offices. Shuafat refugee camp, which borders the “ordinary” Shuafat neighborhood but is